

Mathan Kumar

Senior Guidewire Developer | Guidewire Certified Integration Specialist (PolicyCenter · ClaimCenter · BillingCenter)

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Professional Summary

Senior software engineer with 14+ years of experience in insurance technology and deep expertise across the Guidewire ecosystem, including PolicyCenter, ClaimCenter and BillingCenter. Guidewire Certified Integration Specialist in InsuranceSuite 10.0 and Elysian, with hands-on experience in Gosu development, Edge API integrations, workflow automation and enterprise modernisation. Proven success designing integrations between Guidewire and digital platforms using Azure API Management and REST/SOAP services and migrating Guidewire business rules to Java/Spring Boot microservices. Led an initiative that reduced quote-processing latency by approximately **73%, from 8.2 to 2.2 seconds**. Currently leads and mentors an engineering team at Hastings Direct while delivering complex Guidewire modernisation and digital integration programmes.

Core Technical Skills

- **Guidewire Platform:** Full Suite — PolicyCenter, ClaimCenter, BillingCenter, ContactManager (versions 8, 9 & 10.x, incl. Elysian), Gosu scripting, PCF configuration, GX Model/payload generation, Edge API integration layer, plugin-based customization framework, activity/workflow automation, batch processing, event messaging, inbound file integration, Guidewire Studio (IntelliJ-based IDE)
- **Integration & Middleware:** Azure API Management (policy-driven gateway design, protocol transformation, circuit-breaker/kill-switch patterns, reusable policy modules), JWT/OAuth2, REST & SOAP web services, multi-brand authentication/CORS configuration
- **Backend Engineering:** Java (8–17)/J2EE, Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Maven multi-module architecture, microservices design, concurrent/parallel processing, data structures & algorithms
- **Cloud & DevOps:** Microsoft Azure (APIM, Application Insights), Docker, Azure DevOps & GitHub Actions CI/CD
- **Frontend:** React (16–19), TypeScript, Redux Toolkit/RTK Query, redux-saga, React Router, Context API, styled-components, i18next
- **Quality Engineering:** JUnit 5, Mockito, AssertJ, JaCoCo, Jest, React Testing Library, Postman, SQL & PL/SQL

Certifications

Certification	Issuer	Date
Guidewire Certified Specialist – InsuranceSuite Integration (Elysian)	Guidewire Software	Dec 2023
Specialist Certification – InsuranceSuite 10.0 Integration	Guidewire Software	Aug 2019
Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)	Microsoft	Dec 2022
Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Fundamentals (DP-900)	Microsoft	Dec 2022
Docker Foundations Professional Certificate	Docker, Inc.	Jul 2025
Learning GitHub Actions	LinkedIn Learning	Jul 2025
Java Foundations Professional Certificate	JetBrains	Dec 2025

Professional Experience

Hastings Direct — Bexhill, UK

Jun 2020 – Present, 6 yrs 3+ months

Senior Software Engineer – Guidewire Platform Modernisation Lead

Dec 2025 – Present

- Leading the modernization of Hastings Direct's motor-insurance quoting platform, migrating the central quote-orchestration logic — previously implemented in Guidewire PolicyCenter (Gosu) — into a Java/Spring Boot orchestration service that now sits at the core of the platform, preserving full business-rule parity with the legacy system
- The service receives quote requests over SOAP from two distinct channels — Guidewire itself (call-centre new business, renewals, and mid-term adjustments) and price-comparison aggregators (Private Car and Motorcycle direct quotes) — fans each request out to five specialised downstream microservices (validation, enrichment, insurer pricing, retail pricing, and search/retrieve), and aggregates the results into a single response
- Re-architected the orchestration flow to run these downstream calls concurrently rather than sequentially, cutting end-to-end quote latency by ~73% (8.2s → 2.2s)
- Built in resilience and traceability by design: correlation-ID propagation across every downstream call, asynchronous request/response persistence that never blocks the quote pipeline, and graceful degradation so a failed renewal quote returns safely rather than surfacing an error back to Guidewire

- Own the platform's integration with core pricing partners — Polaris (insurer risk pricing/scoring) and Earnix (retail pricing) — and champion 100%-test-coverage and automated quality-gate discipline across the team
- Line-manage and mentor a team of engineers; contribute to platform-wide architecture decisions

Senior Development Analyst — Guidewire PolicyCenter Developer

Jun 2020 – Feb 2023

- Owned the end-to-end aggregator new-business quote journey in Guidewire PolicyCenter: retrieving a quote generated on an external price-comparison platform and converting it into a PolicyCenter Account, Submission, and multi-brand set of Policy Periods, triggered directly from the quote search screen
- Built the automatic rerate logic that detects a stale or expired aggregator quote on retrieval and transparently re-prices it through Guidewire's rating engine before presenting it to the underwriter or customer, rather than surfacing out-of-date figures
- Implemented the web-service integration between the aggregator quote database and PolicyCenter, including the product-specific mapping logic (Private Car, Home, Motorcycle, Commercial Van) that carries pricing, discount, commission, and tax data from the pricing partners (Polaris/Earnix) into the policy record
- Designed the concurrent multi-version rating step that prices every competing brand/scheme quote in parallel through Guidewire's rating engine, followed by automated underwriting-referral evaluation

React Developer

Feb 2023 – Dec 2025

- Delivered a React/TypeScript self-service digital claims platform (Total Loss and Repair journeys), integrating with Guidewire ClaimCenter through an Azure API Management gateway rather than Guidewire's native UI
- Designed and maintained the Azure APIM integration layer fronting ClaimCenter: translating Guidewire's native protocol into clean REST APIs for the frontend, enforcing authentication across three consumer brands, and building a kill-switch mechanism to safely take the service offline without a redeploy
- Implemented a structured web-analytics/event-tracking layer (custom event emitter feeding a GTM-style data layer) and delivered full Jest/React Testing Library unit coverage

Senior Development Analyst — Guidewire ClaimCenter Developer

Feb 2023 – Dec 2025

- Developed Gosu-based backend services on ClaimCenter's Edge API layer, extending Guidewire's standard plugin framework with Hastings-specific business rules while preserving out-of-the-box platform behaviour
- Built the Total Loss valuation service consumed by the digital claims platform — calculating settlement figures (market value, adjustments, excess, finance/lease payouts) and handling the policyholders accept/reject decision end-to-end, including automated payment triggering
- Designed the claims activity and workflow automation for Total Loss cases: automatically raising the right customer actions (photo upload, finance documents, bank details, licence checks), chasing unresponsive customers, and generating review summaries for the claims team
- Contributed to First Notification of Loss (FNOL) claim intake processing, including claim registration, location geocoding, and automated claim closure for notification-only cases

LV= — Specialist Integration Engineer (Contract)

Nov 2019 – May 2020

Contracted as a specialist integration engineer at one of the UK's largest insurers, delivering full-stack data integration solutions across core insurance platforms.

- Designed and built API integrations (REST and SOAP) between core policy management systems and external aggregator platforms, handling complex data transformation and business rule enforcement
- Implemented end-to-end integrations across billing and policy systems, writing well-structured, maintainable backend code in Java and Gosu
- Produced technical documentation

EY — Technical Manager

Nov 2014 – Nov 2019

Client: ALFA Insurance Corporation (Alabama, Georgia & Mississippi, US) — Guidewire full-suite implementation

- Delivered a full-suite Guidewire implementation (PolicyCenter, BillingCenter, ClaimCenter, ContactManager — versions 8, 9 & 10.x) for ALFA Insurance Corporation, enabling the client to manage millions of customers' insurance details across Business Owners, Property, and Personal Auto lines
- Drove a wide range of platform customizations across the full Guidewire suite and automated communication between multiple downstream systems, removing manual effort from the client's insurance operations
- Owned the responsibility of delivering an automatic bulk invoice processing, FNOL creation, ISO integration, SIMSOL
- Technologies: Guidewire Gosu, Java/J2EE, data structures, SQL & PL/SQL, Guidewire Studio (IntelliJ-based IDE)

Additional Experience (Pre-Guidewire)

- IGATE — Senior Software Engineer | Jan 2014 – Nov 2014 — Gathered client requirements and implemented cross-cutting solutions using Spring MVC, PL/SQL, JBoss, and AWS S3.
- Tech Mahindra — Software Engineer | Jun 2011 – Dec 2013 — Early software engineering foundation role.

Projects

ShopFlow — Multi-Tenant Retail SaaS Platform (shopflow.uk)

Personal project — sole architect, developer, and operator (backend, frontend, infrastructure, deployment)

- Designed and built a multi-tenant SaaS platform enabling independent shops to sell online via their own subdomain storefront with tenant isolation, role-based access across shop-admin/customer/super-admin tiers, and stateless JWT authentication
- **Backend:** Java 21, Spring Boot 3.2, Spring Data JPA, Spring Security, PostgreSQL with Flyway-versioned schema migrations, layered controller→service→repository architecture, springdoc-openapi/Swagger documentation
- **Frontend:** React 19, Vite, TypeScript, TanStack Query, Zustand, React Hook Form + Zod, Tailwind CSS
- **Cloud/Infra:** Cloudflare Pages hosting the frontend; a custom Cloudflare Worker rewriting subdomain-to-tenant identity in the request path; Cloudflare R2 object storage with presigned direct-to-bucket uploads (AWS SDK v2) and on-the-fly image resizing/WebP conversion; Docker Compose deployment (Spring Boot API + PostgreSQL) on a self-managed VPS behind Cloudflare DNS/CDN
- Owns the product end-to-end — from DNS/SSL configuration to database schema evolution to production monitoring — with no platform or ops team

Education

Anna University — Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech.), Information Technology (2007 – 2011)